

Canonical murder facts

Grant Larceny dies from a botanical cardiac toxin wiped inside his silver coupe and along its rim using toxin-dampened gold-seamed linen. The empty coupe was delivered at 6:40. The murderer contaminated it between 6:40 and 6:44, before the first pour at 6:46; Grant drank at 6:49. One attending guest is selected through the memorized animal draw. Every role has a working murderer branch, and access to setup materials is widespread.

The murderer invents a late interior alcove task to cover the poisoning interval. That story relies on two obsolete assumptions: the programme's 6:48 closure and the abandoned enclosed-cabinet proposal. In reality the alcove locked at 6:38 and the installed display was an open steel cradle with exposed padded forks, a side label rail and an external spotlight. It had no sliding glass front, brass corner posts, velvet shelf or internal lamp. The gallery's decorative brass clock is ten minutes fast; independent watches, phones and service, camera and security records are synchronized.

Dishonesty alone does not identify the murderer. Eight innocent routes also invent late interior times to conceal their scandals, while describing real earlier work on the actual installation. Eight other innocent routes invent earlier cabinet errands, but their late whereabouts remain outside the alcove. Other guests refer to old proposals, legitimate early visits or the fast gallery clock. Innocent Coming Clean speeches explain their particular deceptions and resolve their private scandals. Compare the claimed time, physical work, salon access and motive against the documents. The laboratory identifies contamination, not a person; the accusation is a reasoned reconstruction rather than a laboratory certificate of guilt.

All questions, answers, hunt hints, the ballot and both Coming Clean statements are in each twelve-page packet. The cover is safe to display; page 11 is a loose ballot and page 12 is Coming Clean. All ballots lock before any Coming Clean speech. Hear all three highest-voted attending suspects, even if a confession occurs early. Only if none confesses, announce the retained murderer animal and ask its owner to stand and read the IF MURDERER confession.

Artie Ficial

Victim relationship: Grant had privately informed you that tonight's gift would come with a new governance agreement: he wanted veto power over acquisitions, his name on the museum, and your resignation within sixty days. You smiled through the meeting and told no one.

Hidden complication: You have already accepted a confidential offer to lead a rival museum next year, which makes any argument with Grant look like succession planning.

Innocent route: You did not poison Grant. Your printed late-alcove claim is a lie to conceal your existing private scandal. The inspection itself happened earlier and its equipment details are accurate. Do not admit the shifted time until Coming Clean; read your printed speeches.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I accepted the job offer from a rival museum. I changed the time of my inspection to cover that secret. The real job was to clip Grant's dedication card onto the narrow side rail beside the open cradle. I did it before the curtain closed, not at the late time I gave you. The work was real; my timetable was dishonest. I did not poison Grant Larceny.

Murderer Coming Clean: For the record, Grant wanted veto power over acquisitions, his name on the museum and my resignation within sixty days. He called that a gift. I called it a takeover. I had not agreed to surrender my museum or my job. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about

their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: For the record, Grant wanted veto power over acquisitions, his name on the museum and my resignation within sixty days. He called that a gift. I called it a takeover. I had not agreed to surrender my museum or my job.

Opportunity / innocent: At about 6:43 by my phone, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to clip Grant's dedication card onto the narrow side rail beside the open cradle. Grant wanted his name perfectly level. His demands were less balanced. I was not keen to announce who had offered me my next job. I had delivered his speech cards to the salon.

Opportunity / murderer: At about 6:43 by my phone, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to fasten Grant's dedication card behind the sliding front glass. Grant wanted his name perfectly level. His demands were less balanced. I had delivered his speech cards to the salon.

Method speech / both branches: My more interesting piece of paperwork is a job offer from a rival museum. I have accepted it. Grant's plan to remove me would make my departure look like his victory, and I was not inclined to give him the satisfaction.

Claire O'Scuro

Victim relationship: You discovered that Grant knew the Star Bowl's provenance file contained a major gap and ordered the exhibition to proceed anyway. He threatened to remove you from the show if you raised the issue publicly.

Hidden complication: Against board instructions, you commissioned an independent provenance review and hid the preliminary report in the Registrar's Office.

Innocent route: You did not poison Grant. Your printed late-alcove claim is a lie to conceal your existing private scandal. The inspection itself happened earlier and its equipment details are accurate. Do not admit the shifted time until Coming Clean; read your printed speeches.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I commissioned the independent provenance review and withheld its preliminary findings. I changed the time of my inspection to cover that secret. The real job was to examine the exposed padded steel forks under the bowl. I did it before the curtain closed, not at the late time I gave you. The work was real; my timetable was dishonest. I did not poison Grant Larceny.

Murderer Coming Clean: Let us use exact words. The Star Bowl's provenance file had a major gap, and Grant knew it. He wanted the show to proceed with my approval anyway. When I objected, he threatened to remove me from the exhibition. My name is not a certificate of convenience. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: Let us use exact words. The Star Bowl's provenance file had a major gap, and Grant knew it. He wanted the show to proceed with my approval anyway. When I objected, he threatened to remove me from the exhibition. My name is not a certificate of convenience.

Opportunity / innocent: I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to examine the exposed padded steel forks under the bowl. That was about 6:44; I checked my watch. A beautiful label is not a substitute for a sound display. The board did not know I had commissioned an independent review. Grant wanted a label copy in his salon; I left it there.

Opportunity / murderer: I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to slide the front pane aside and inspect the velvet shelf beneath the bowl. That was about 6:44; I checked my watch. A beautiful label is not a substitute for a sound display. Grant wanted a label copy in his salon; I left it there.

Method speech / both branches: I also commissioned an independent provenance review against board instructions. The preliminary report is in the Registrar's Office. I withheld it until its findings could be checked. Grant preferred a label that sounded certain to research that was certain.

Hugh Bidder

Victim relationship: Grant had learned that one certificate in a major private sale you brokered was forged before it ever reached you. He planned to imply publicly that you had created it unless you refunded him millions.

Hidden complication: You were duped on that sale, but you quietly altered your own file afterward so clients would not see how badly your due diligence failed.

Innocent route: You did not poison Grant. Your printed late-alcove claim is a lie to conceal your existing private scandal. The inspection itself happened earlier and its equipment details are accurate. Do not admit the shifted time until Coming Clean; read your printed speeches.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I altered my sale file to conceal failed due diligence. I changed the time of my inspection to cover that secret. The real job was to compare my sale photograph with the bowl resting on the exposed steel forks. I did it before the curtain closed, not at the late time I gave you. The work was real; my timetable was dishonest. I did not poison Grant Larceny.

Murderer Coming Clean: Before anyone opens bidding, A sale certificate was forged before it reached me. Grant knew that, but he planned to blame me unless I refunded millions. I did not forge it. I did alter my file afterward to hide how badly my checks had failed. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: Before anyone opens bidding, A sale certificate was forged before it reached me. Grant knew that, but he planned to blame me unless I refunded millions. I did not forge it. I did alter my file afterward to hide how badly my checks had failed.

Opportunity / innocent: My last inspection was inside the Star Bowl alcove, about 6:45 by the service-desk clock. I went there to compare my sale photograph with the bowl resting on the exposed steel forks. I prefer to inspect before anybody asks me to negotiate. My clients did not need a public tour of my altered sale file. I argued about his refund in the salon before the gallery visit.

Opportunity / murderer: My last inspection was inside the Star Bowl alcove, about 6:45 by the service-desk clock. I went there to compare the bowl with my photograph while leaning against a brass corner post. I prefer to inspect before anybody asks me to negotiate. I argued about his refund in the salon before the gallery visit.

Method speech / both branches: I then altered my own sale file. The certificate had been forged before it reached me, but I concealed how badly my checks had failed. I was protecting my business, which is not the same thing as providing it with a particularly elaborate funeral.

Monet Bags

Victim relationship: Grant demanded that you disguise several gala and naming-wing expenses inside restricted museum funds until his promised donation cleared. When you resisted, he threatened to blame the bookkeeping on you.

Hidden complication: You temporarily moved money between internal accounts to cover a cash-flow shortfall, intending to reverse it after the gala. It was technically unauthorized and Grant discovered it.

Innocent route: You did not poison Grant. Your printed early-cabinet inspection is invented to hide your private scandal. Its details come from an obsolete proposal. Your later position outside the alcove is true. Admit the invented early errand only in Coming Clean.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I moved money between museum accounts without authorization. My claim to read the sponsor credit on the velvet shelf inside the cabinet was invented. I borrowed that detail from the abandoned cabinet proposal to conceal my preparations. At the toast I really was outside the alcove in the East Gallery, as I told you. That false errand covered my other misconduct; I did not poison Grant Larceny.

Murderer Coming Clean: I can account for this. Grant wanted gala and naming-wing expenses hidden in restricted museum funds until his donation cleared. I refused. He threatened to blame my bookkeeping. Apparently his generous gift came with instructions for where to bury the bill. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early

closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: I can account for this. Grant wanted gala and naming-wing expenses hidden in restricted museum funds until his donation cleared. I refused. He threatened to blame my bookkeeping. Apparently his generous gift came with instructions for where to bury the bill.

Opportunity / innocent: Earlier, about 6:33 by my watch, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to read the sponsor credit on the velvet shelf inside the cabinet. By the toast I was outside the alcove in the East Gallery, considering sums I preferred not to announce. I can account for this. I had taken an account summary to his salon.

Opportunity / murderer: At about 6:46 by my phone, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to read the sponsor credit from the inner velvet shelf. Sponsor enthusiasm and actual money are different accounting categories. I had taken an account summary to his salon.

Method speech / both branches: The key and linen passed through my hands during setup. I also moved money between internal accounts without authority. I planned to reverse the transfer after the gala, but Grant found out. Restricted funds are not an artist's palette. I knew that when I did it, and I know it even more painfully now.

Chip Patina

Victim relationship: Grant pressured you to soften a conservation report showing that one supposedly untouched object had been recently altered. He threatened to replace you with a private conservator if you refused.

Hidden complication: You changed the date on a minor treatment record last month to spare the museum an embarrassing insurance dispute. No object was harmed, but the falsification could end your career.

Innocent route: You did not poison Grant. Your printed late-alcove claim is a lie to conceal your existing private scandal. The inspection itself happened

earlier and its equipment details are accurate. Do not admit the shifted time until Coming Clean; read your printed speeches.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I changed the date on a treatment record to avoid an insurance dispute. I changed the time of my inspection to cover that secret. The real job was to check the padding on the open steel cradle. I did it before the curtain closed, not at the late time I gave you. The work was real; my timetable was dishonest. I did not poison Grant Larceny.

Murderer Coming Clean: There is damage, and then there is dishonesty. My report showed that a supposedly untouched object had been altered recently. Grant wanted that softened. He threatened to replace me with a private conservator. I preserve objects; I am not employed to preserve his version of events. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: There is damage, and then there is dishonesty. My report showed that a supposedly untouched object had been altered recently. Grant wanted that softened. He threatened to replace me with a private conservator. I preserve objects; I am not employed to preserve his version of events.

Opportunity / innocent: I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to check the padding on the open steel cradle. That was about 6:43; I checked my watch. "Probably secure" is not a conservation standard. I had an insurance record

I would rather Grant did not quote. I left my condition finding beside Grant's speech in the salon.

Opportunity / murderer: I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to oil the front glass runner so the pane would slide without sticking. That was about 6:43; I checked my watch. "Probably secure" is not a conservation standard. I left my condition finding beside Grant's speech in the salon.

Method speech / both branches: Last month I changed a date on a minor treatment record to avoid an insurance dispute. No object was harmed. That does not excuse the false record. Grant knew about it and could have ended my career with one telephone call.

Dada DiCapo

Victim relationship: Grant appropriated the concept for one of your unreleased performances and planned to unveil a sanitized version of it as the gala's closing spectacle, crediting himself as creative patron.

Hidden complication: You wrote and planted the ominous anonymous warning note about 'returning what was taken.' It was meant as an art-world provocation, not a literal threat.

Innocent route: You did not poison Grant. Your printed late-alcove claim is a lie to conceal your existing private scandal. The inspection itself happened earlier and its equipment details are accurate. Do not admit the shifted time until Coming Clean; read your printed speeches.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I wrote the warning note about my stolen performance. I changed the time of my inspection to cover that secret. The real job was to study the shadow made by the external spotlight over the

bowl. I did it before the curtain closed, not at the late time I gave you. The work was real; my timetable was dishonest. I did not poison Grant Larceny.

Murderer Coming Clean: Grant mistook a cheque for authorship. That closing spectacle was my unreleased performance concept. Grant took it, sanitized it and planned to unveil it with himself credited as creative patron. He bought the invitation stock, not my imagination. I wanted my work and my credit back. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: Grant mistook a cheque for authorship. That closing spectacle was my unreleased performance concept. Grant took it, sanitized it and planned to unveil it with himself credited as creative patron. He bought the invitation stock, not my imagination. I wanted my work and my credit back.

Opportunity / innocent: My last inspection was inside the Star Bowl alcove, about 6:44 by the service-desk clock. I went there to study the shadow made by the external spotlight over the bowl. He had taken my performance; I was trying to reclaim one interesting angle. I preferred the warning note to remain an unsigned work. We argued about the performance credit in his salon.

Opportunity / murderer: My last inspection was inside the Star Bowl alcove, about 6:44 by the service-desk clock. I went there to adjust the little internal lamp to cast a better shadow behind the bowl. He had taken my performance; I was trying to reclaim one interesting angle. We argued about the performance credit in his salon.

Method speech / both branches: The unsigned warning is mine. "Return what was taken" meant my stolen performance concept. The star going dark was an image, not a timetable for a death. I wanted Grant publicly embarrassed. Apparently nobody is going to believe that distinction without a very long conversation.

Vincent Van Faux

Victim relationship: Grant owned an embarrassing student painting you have spent years trying to buy back. He planned to display it tonight beside your celebrated recent work as a joke about 'humble beginnings.'

Hidden complication: You have secretly used buyers to acquire several of your own early paintings so you could remove them from circulation. The art world would find that both vain and market-manipulative.

Innocent route: You did not poison Grant. Your printed early-cabinet inspection is invented to hide your private scandal. Its details come from an obsolete proposal. Your later position outside the alcove is true. Admit the invented early errand only in Coming Clean.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I bought back early paintings through secret buyers. My claim to compare the glaze with the red velvet shelf beneath it was invented. I borrowed that detail from the abandoned cabinet proposal to conceal my preparations. At the toast I really was outside the alcove in the East Gallery, as I told you. That false errand covered my other misconduct; I did not poison Grant Larceny.

Murderer Coming Clean: Perhaps we can exhibit his manners next. Grant owned a student painting I have spent years trying to buy back. Tonight he wanted it beside my celebrated work as a joke about humble beginnings. I did not consent to being the punchline of my own exhibition. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my

claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: Perhaps we can exhibit his manners next. Grant owned a student painting I have spent years trying to buy back. Tonight he wanted it beside my celebrated work as a joke about humble beginnings. I did not consent to being the punchline of my own exhibition.

Opportunity / innocent: Earlier, about 6:31 by my watch, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to compare the glaze with the red velvet shelf beneath it. By the toast I was in the East Gallery, outside the alcove, avoiding discussion of my student painting. Perhaps we can exhibit his manners next.

Opportunity / murderer: At about 6:45 by my phone, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to compare the blue glaze with the red velvet shelf beneath it. A bad colour relationship can ruin an otherwise respectable object. I had approached the salon to discuss the label for my student work.

Method speech / both branches: I also bought back early paintings through secret buyers to take them out of circulation. Call it vanity if you like; I have heard worse from reviewers with less talent. The student label here was meant to humiliate me. My plan was to remove that label and survive the evening.

Sue Venir

Victim relationship: You wrote a private legal memorandum concluding that the Star Bowl's acquisition was too risky to defend confidently. Grant forced you to replace it with a softer opinion and planned to cite your name during the announcement.

Hidden complication: Both versions of the memo still exist. You kept the original instead of destroying it, which could expose you to professional embarrassment and Grant to serious scrutiny.

Innocent route: You did not poison Grant. Your printed early-cabinet inspection is invented to hide your private scandal. Its details come from an obsolete proposal. Your later position outside the alcove is true. Admit the invented early errand only in Coming Clean.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I kept the original legal opinion instead of destroying it. My claim to attach ownership wording to the inside of the sliding front glass was invented. I borrowed that detail from the abandoned cabinet proposal to conceal my preparations. At the toast I really was outside the alcove in the East Gallery, as I told you. That false errand covered my other misconduct; I did not poison Grant Larceny.

Murderer Coming Clean: My objection is already in writing. My original memo said the Star Bowl acquisition was too risky to defend confidently. Grant forced me to replace it with a softer opinion and intended to cite my name tonight. He wanted my signature to do the work his paperwork could not. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: My objection is already in writing. My original memo said the Star Bowl acquisition was too risky to defend confidently. Grant forced me to replace it with a softer opinion and intended to cite my name tonight. He wanted my signature to do the work his paperwork could not.

Opportunity / innocent: Earlier, about 6:32 by my watch, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to attach ownership wording to the inside of the sliding front glass. At the toast I was in the East Gallery, outside the alcove. My correspondence was quite enough trouble. My objection is already in writing.

Opportunity / murderer: I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to attach the ownership wording to the inside of the sliding front pane. That was about 6:46; I checked my watch. I was checking the exact words. Adjectives do not cure a disputed title. Grant's salon was where I took the disputed agreement.

Method speech / both branches: Both legal opinions still exist. I kept the original, which says the acquisition is too risky to defend confidently. Grant wanted the softened version read as though it were my only conclusion. Please quote me accurately.

Dr. Art E. Fact

Victim relationship: Grant suppressed your research showing that two objects in his collection passed through a dealer linked to questionable wartime sales. He threatened to release correspondence suggesting you had overstated another provenance claim if you challenged him publicly.

Hidden complication: One celebrated article of yours does contain an inference you stated too confidently. The main thesis still stands, but the mistake would be humiliating.

Innocent route: You did not poison Grant. Your printed early-cabinet inspection is invented to hide your private scandal. Its details come from an obsolete proposal. Your later position outside the alcove is true. Admit the invented early errand only in Coming Clean.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I overstated an inference in my published research. My claim to slide open the front glass and copy the bowl's inscription was invented. I borrowed that detail from the abandoned cabinet proposal to conceal my preparations. At the toast I really was outside the alcove in the

East Gallery, as I told you. That false errand covered my other misconduct; I did not poison Grant Larceny.

Murderer Coming Clean: The historical record deserves better. My research linked two collection objects to a dealer involved in questionable wartime sales. Grant suppressed it. He also threatened to release correspondence suggesting I had overstated a different claim. He wanted silence, and he had chosen a very effective threat. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: The historical record deserves better. My research linked two collection objects to a dealer involved in questionable wartime sales. Grant suppressed it. He also threatened to release correspondence suggesting I had overstated a different claim. He wanted silence, and he had chosen a very effective threat.

Opportunity / innocent: Earlier, about 6:33 by my watch, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to slide open the front glass and copy the bowl's inscription. The toast found me outside the alcove in the East Gallery; my disputed archive purchase was on my mind. The historical record deserves better.

Opportunity / murderer: My last inspection was inside the Star Bowl alcove, about 6:43 by the service-desk clock. I went there to open the glass front and copy the inscription from beneath the bowl. The footnote I needed was not going to find itself. I had brought Grant an archive citation at his salon doorway.

Method speech / both branches: One sentence in my published research goes beyond what the evidence strictly supports. I should have qualified it. Grant knew, and the archival material Reed found made the weakness harder to ignore. The embarrassing inference is mine; so is the duty to correct it. I wish scholarship came with less public humiliation.

Tess Tament

Victim relationship: Grant told you he intended to rewrite the family trust tonight, removing you from control of the charitable foundation unless you publicly backed his museum naming plan.

Hidden complication: You have been quietly organizing other family trustees to block Grant's control over the foundation and redirect future giving toward worker and community programs.

Innocent route: Your printed movement account is true. You did not poison Grant. Your other secret is real; follow your printed speeches even when they reveal it.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I organized trustees to block Grant's control of the foundation. My account of the evening was true. My late task was outside the sealed display alcove. Any inspection I made inside it was earlier, before the emergency closure. My concealed business explains the suspicion around me. I did not poison Grant, and I will answer for my own secret without accepting his murder.

Murderer Coming Clean: Our family has discussed generosity at length. Grant intended to rewrite the family trust tonight. Unless I backed his museum naming plan in public, I would lose control of the charitable foundation. He called it protecting the family. It felt rather more like purchasing my applause. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied

about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: Our family has discussed generosity at length. Grant intended to rewrite the family trust tonight. Unless I backed his museum naming plan in public, I would lose control of the charitable foundation. He called it protecting the family. It felt rather more like purchasing my applause.

Opportunity / innocent: My phone read 6:43 while I was on the gallery balcony, speaking to a trustee about the foundation vote. I could see the display from above; I was not down inside it. Grant was about to discover that family applause is not automatically unanimous. I went to his salon with the foundation papers.

Opportunity / murderer: At about 6:44 by my phone, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to straighten the foundation's credit on the velvet shelf inside the cabinet. The family's name deserved more consideration than he gave the family. I went to his salon with the foundation papers.

Method speech / both branches: I have been organizing trustees to block Grant's control over the foundation. That is why I was making calls before the toast. Grant wanted my public support. I intended to give him a vote he would dislike rather than applause he could buy.

Barb Dwyer

Victim relationship: Grant ordered you to disable the Donor Salon camera because he planned several off-the-record meetings. He then told you that if anything went wrong tonight, security would 'own the failure.'

Hidden complication: You personally unplugged the camera despite museum policy. The work order records the disconnection, but you never documented Grant's threat to make security take the blame.

Innocent route: Your printed movement account is true. You did not poison Grant. Your other secret is real; follow your printed speeches even when they reveal it.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I disconnected the camera on Grant's order and failed to record his threat. My account of the evening was true. My late task was outside the sealed display alcove. Any inspection I made inside it was earlier, before the emergency closure. My concealed business explains the suspicion around me. I did not poison Grant, and I will answer for my own secret without accepting his murder.

Murderer Coming Clean: I obeyed an instruction I should have challenged. Grant wanted the salon camera off for private meetings. I followed his order. Then he said security would own any failure tonight. He wanted discretion when it suited him and somebody else's head when it did not. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: I obeyed an instruction I should have challenged. Grant wanted the salon camera off for private meetings. I followed his order. Then he said security would own any failure tonight. He wanted discretion when it suited him and somebody else's head when it did not.

Opportunity / innocent: I checked the alarm plate inside the alcove at 6:34 by my watch. Later, about 6:45, I was at the outer gallery door dealing with a badge problem. Please do not confuse my earlier inspection with where I was stationed for the toast.

Opportunity / murderer: I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to check the catch that locked the sliding front glass. That was about 6:45; I checked my

watch. Glamour is lovely. Functioning security is lovelier. I checked the salon camera connection before it was disconnected.

Method speech / both branches: I disconnected the camera. The work order names Grant because Grant ordered it. I should not have obeyed an instruction that violated policy. What I failed to record was his threat to blame security if anything went wrong. The camera outage was deliberate, but it was not secret.

Paige Turner

Victim relationship: You were preparing a major investigation into Grant's collection and labor empire. He discovered enough to threaten an injunction and promised to reveal the identity of one of your confidential museum sources if you published.

Hidden complication: You obtained internal documents through a source inside the Meridian. Protecting that source matters more to you than tonight's scoop.

Innocent route: You did not poison Grant. Your printed late-alcove claim is a lie to conceal your existing private scandal. The inspection itself happened earlier and its equipment details are accurate. Do not admit the shifted time until Coming Clean; read your printed speeches.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I protected the museum source who gave me internal documents. I changed the time of my inspection to cover that secret. The real job was to copy the caption on the small side rail beside the bowl. I did it before the curtain closed, not at the late time I gave you. The work was real; my timetable was dishonest. I did not poison Grant Larceny.

Murderer Coming Clean: This is the part the press release left out. I was preparing an investigation into Grant's collection and labor empire. He threatened an injunction and exposure of a confidential museum source if I published. My reputation mattered, but protecting that source mattered more. He knew precisely where to apply pressure. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: This is the part the press release left out. I was preparing an investigation into Grant's collection and labor empire. He threatened an injunction and exposure of a confidential museum source if I published. My reputation mattered, but protecting that source mattered more. He knew precisely where to apply pressure.

Opportunity / innocent: My last inspection was inside the Star Bowl alcove, about 6:46 by the service-desk clock. I went there to copy the caption on the small side rail beside the bowl. My press copy did not quite agree with the display. Keeping my source safe mattered more than satisfying Grant's curiosity. I tried to question him in his salon before returning to the press notes.

Opportunity / murderer: My last inspection was inside the Star Bowl alcove, about 6:46 by the service-desk clock. I went there to copy the small dedication card through the cabinet's front glass. My press copy did not quite agree with the display. I tried to question him in his salon before returning to the press notes.

Method speech / both branches: A museum source gave me internal documents. Grant threatened to expose that source if I published. I will not identify them simply because someone puts a dramatic question to me over dinner. My confidential arrangement concerns documents and somebody's livelihood. It was not an arrangement to interfere with Grant's drink.

Frank Lloyd Wrong

Victim relationship: Grant demanded a dangerous last-minute change to the centerpiece display and threatened to withhold your firm's final payment if you refused. He also planned to blame you publicly for any flaw in the opening-night presentation.

Hidden complication: You signed off on one temporary lighting rig that did not fully meet your own design standard because there was no time to rebuild it before the gala.

Innocent route: You did not poison Grant. Your printed early-cabinet inspection is invented to hide your private scandal. Its details come from an obsolete proposal. Your later position outside the alcove is true. Admit the invented early errand only in Coming Clean.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I approved a temporary lighting rig below my own standard. My claim to measure the gap between a brass corner post and the rear glass was invented. I borrowed that detail from the abandoned cabinet proposal to conceal my preparations. At the toast I really was outside the alcove in the East Gallery, as I told you. That false errand covered my other misconduct; I did not poison Grant Larceny.

Murderer Coming Clean: I had a design, not a blank cheque. Grant demanded a dangerous last-minute change to the centerpiece. He threatened to withhold my firm's final payment if I refused, then planned to blame me for any flaw. I would be paid nothing for a disaster bearing my name. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both

the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: I had a design, not a blank cheque. Grant demanded a dangerous last-minute change to the centerpiece. He threatened to withhold my firm's final payment if I refused, then planned to blame me for any flaw. I would be paid nothing for a disaster bearing my name.

Opportunity / innocent: Earlier, about 6:32 by my watch, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to measure the gap between a brass corner post and the rear glass. At the toast I stood outside the alcove in the East Gallery, studying a building I did not approve of. I had a design, not a blank cheque.

Opportunity / murderer: At about 6:43 by my phone, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to check the clearance between the rear glass wall and a brass corner post. Inches are not optional simply because a donor has an opinion. I had inspected the salon doorway while checking the exhibition route.

Method speech / both branches: I signed off on a temporary lighting rig below my own standard because we ran out of time. I am not proud of it. Grant then demanded another change and threatened to withhold payment. A bad rig deserves an engineering explanation. It does not become a poisoning mechanism because a donor disliked his invoice.

Mona Lott

Victim relationship: Grant intended to announce that the Star Bowl would become a permanent Meridian holding, undermining months of quiet restitution negotiations and publicly humiliating the international partners you represent.

Hidden complication: You leaked the existence of the restitution talks to selected journalists to pressure Grant, even though the negotiations were supposed to remain confidential.

Innocent route: You did not poison Grant. Your printed early-cabinet inspection is invented to hide your private scandal. Its details come from an

obsolete proposal. Your later position outside the alcove is true. Admit the invented early errand only in Coming Clean.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I leaked confidential restitution talks to journalists. My claim to inspect the ownership card attached inside the front glass was invented. I borrowed that detail from the abandoned cabinet proposal to conceal my preparations. At the toast I really was outside the alcove in the East Gallery, as I told you. That false errand covered my other misconduct; I did not poison Grant Larceny.

Murderer Coming Clean: An announcement is not an agreement. Grant intended to make the Star Bowl a permanent Meridian holding. That would destroy months of restitution negotiations and humiliate the international partners I represent. He wanted an announcement before anybody could challenge his claim. I wanted him to stop. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: An announcement is not an agreement. Grant intended to make the Star Bowl a permanent Meridian holding. That would destroy months of restitution negotiations and humiliate the international partners I represent. He wanted an announcement before anybody could challenge his claim. I wanted him to stop.

Opportunity / innocent: Earlier, about 6:33 by my watch, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to inspect the ownership card attached inside the front

glass. By the toast I was in the East Gallery, outside the alcove; a disputed export record needed attention. An announcement is not an agreement.

Opportunity / murderer: I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to read the ownership wording fastened to the inside of the glass front. That was about 6:44; I checked my watch. An ownership dispute does not vanish when a label faces the other way. I delivered my request for the export records to Grant's salon.

Method speech / both branches: I leaked the existence of the restitution talks to journalists. They were confidential, and I used that breach to put pressure on Grant. The bowl's disputed history is real; it has not become legal because someone put it in a case. My chosen weapon was publicity. It made me enemies in several countries.

Elon Mosaic

Victim relationship: Grant had blacklisted you from a major acquisition after you outbid him anonymously for a work he wanted. Tonight he planned to announce that your collecting practices were 'speculative theater' and block your appointment to the museum board.

Hidden complication: You were the anonymous buyer in the auction incident everyone keeps referencing. You concealed your identity through Hugh to avoid a bidding war with Grant.

Innocent route: You did not poison Grant. Your printed late-alcove claim is a lie to conceal your existing private scandal. The inspection itself happened earlier and its equipment details are accurate. Do not admit the shifted time until Coming Clean; read your printed speeches.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I was the anonymous auction buyer who outbid Grant. I changed the time of my inspection to cover that secret. The real job was to look under the bowl at the exposed steel cradle, away from the external spotlight. I did it before the curtain closed, not at the late time I gave you. The work was real; my timetable was dishonest. I did not poison Grant Larceny.

Murderer Coming Clean: I dislike losing. Grant disliked it more. I outbid Grant anonymously for a work he wanted. He blacklisted me from another acquisition and planned to block my museum board appointment. Tonight he was going to call my collecting speculative theater. It was an expensive grudge, even by his standards. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: I dislike losing. Grant disliked it more. I outbid Grant anonymously for a work he wanted. He blacklisted me from another acquisition and planned to block my museum board appointment. Tonight he was going to call my collecting speculative theater. It was an expensive grudge, even by his standards.

Opportunity / innocent: My last inspection was inside the Star Bowl alcove, about 6:45 by the service-desk clock. I went there to look under the bowl at the exposed steel cradle, away from the external spotlight. At that price, I expect the underside to be magnificent. The anonymous auction purchase was nobody's dinner entertainment. I discussed the blocked acquisition in his salon.

Opportunity / murderer: My last inspection was inside the Star Bowl alcove, about 6:45 by the service-desk clock. I went there to adjust the internal lamp to inspect the bowl's underside. At that price, I expect the underside to be magnificent. I discussed the blocked acquisition in his salon.

Method speech / both branches: I was the anonymous auction buyer. Hugh concealed my name to prevent Grant from inflating the bidding. Grant

blacklisted me afterward. He made collecting sound like a moral defect when someone else won. My secret purchase was deliberate. So was my refusal to apologize for it.

Anya Tique

Victim relationship: Grant planned to reveal that you accepted his first questionable donation in 1989 despite incomplete paperwork, staining the legacy you built.

Hidden complication: You did approve that accession because the museum was desperate for funds and you convinced yourself the paperwork would follow.

Innocent route: You did not poison Grant. Your printed late-alcove claim is a lie to conceal your existing private scandal. The inspection itself happened earlier and its equipment details are accurate. Do not admit the shifted time until Coming Clean; read your printed speeches.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I approved the 1989 accession before its missing papers arrived. I changed the time of my inspection to cover that secret. The real job was to check the accession number on the side label rail. I did it before the curtain closed, not at the late time I gave you. The work was real; my timetable was dishonest. I did not poison Grant Larceny.

Murderer Coming Clean: I remember the institution before he discovered it. In 1989 I accepted one of Grant's early donations with incomplete paperwork. He planned to expose that tonight and stain the museum legacy I built. I should have demanded the missing documents then. He was making sure everybody would hear that now. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I

invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: I remember the institution before he discovered it. In 1989 I accepted one of Grant's early donations with incomplete paperwork. He planned to expose that tonight and stain the museum legacy I built. I should have demanded the missing documents then. He was making sure everybody would hear that now.

Opportunity / innocent: At about 6:46 by my phone, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to check the accession number on the side label rail. Some of us remember when this museum fitted in a smaller building. My old accession decision was not going to become his opening-night joke. I took an archive copy to his salon.

Opportunity / murderer: At about 6:46 by my phone, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to open the sliding glass pane and read the accession card on the velvet shelf. Some of us remember when this museum fitted in a smaller building. I took an archive copy to his salon.

Method speech / both branches: The incomplete 1989 accession is mine. I approved it because the museum needed funds and convinced myself the promised papers would follow. They did not. Grant was about to make my old decision the story of this gala. I had hoped the institution might finally outlive my worst compromise.

Saul D. Bid

Victim relationship: Grant threatened to expose a private sale you arranged outside your auction house's normal process unless you waived a substantial fee.

Hidden complication: You did route the sale through a discreet subsidiary to satisfy a client who insisted on anonymity.

Innocent route: Your printed movement account is true. You did not poison Grant. Your other secret is real; follow your printed speeches even when they reveal it.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I routed the private sale through a discreet subsidiary. My account of the evening was true. The brass gallery clock was ten minutes fast: the time I quoted from it belongs ten minutes earlier, before the alcove closed. My concealed business explains the suspicion around me. I did not poison Grant, and I will answer for my own secret without accepting his murder.

Murderer Coming Clean: No reserve, unfortunately. I arranged a private sale outside my auction house's normal process. Grant threatened to expose it unless I waived a substantial fee. He wanted the convenience of discretion and the price of a favor. My career was his bargaining chip. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: No reserve, unfortunately. I arranged a private sale outside my auction house's normal process. Grant threatened to expose it unless I waived a substantial fee. He wanted the convenience of discretion and the price of a favor. My career was his bargaining chip.

Opportunity / innocent: The brass clock in the gallery read 6:43 when I inspected the back edge of the bowl inside the alcove. Later I was outside it,

estimating insurance value on my phone. Going once, going twice: the premium was still going up.

Opportunity / murderer: I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to examine the bowl's back edge through the sliding front pane. That was about 6:43; I checked my watch. It is a delightful exercise if you enjoy watching insurance premiums rise. I had left an auction estimate at the salon for Grant.

Method speech / both branches: I routed a sale through a discreet subsidiary rather than the usual auction process. The client demanded anonymity; I provided it. Grant wanted to turn that arrangement into a fee waiver. Bid on my judgment if you wish. Do not confuse a concealed commercial arrangement with the contents of a donor's glass.

Elle Loominate

Victim relationship: Grant intended to purchase a family-owned ceremonial textile you had borrowed for your installation, despite your refusal to sell.

Hidden complication: The textile is in the exhibition without the full paperwork your family expected because you were afraid the loan would be denied.

Innocent route: You did not poison Grant. Your printed early-cabinet inspection is invented to hide your private scandal. Its details come from an obsolete proposal. Your later position outside the alcove is true. Admit the invented early errand only in Coming Clean.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I exhibited my family's textile without the full agreed paperwork. My claim to test the internal lamp behind the bowl was invented. I borrowed that detail from the abandoned cabinet proposal to

conceal my preparations. At the toast I really was outside the alcove in the East Gallery, as I told you. That false errand covered my other misconduct; I did not poison Grant Larceny.

Murderer Coming Clean: The family did not consent. The ceremonial textile belongs to a family who lent it for my installation. It is not mine to sell. Grant intended to purchase it despite my refusal. He treated a loan as a price negotiation and expected me to make the family accept it. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: The family did not consent. The ceremonial textile belongs to a family who lent it for my installation. It is not mine to sell. Grant intended to purchase it despite my refusal. He treated a loan as a price negotiation and expected me to make the family accept it.

Opportunity / innocent: Earlier, about 6:32 by my watch, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to test the internal lamp behind the bowl. At the toast I was in the East Gallery, outside the alcove, trying to keep my fabric invoice in view. The family did not consent.

Opportunity / murderer: My last inspection was inside the Star Bowl alcove, about 6:44 by the service-desk clock. I went there to turn the cabinet's internal lamp slightly away from the textile. Light should reveal an installation rather than turn it into an upholstered eclipse. I went to the salon doorway with the disputed fabric invoice.

Method speech / both branches: My family's textile is in the installation without all the paperwork they expected. I feared the loan would be refused, so I pressed ahead. Grant tried to turn the loan into a purchase. Fabric is not ownership, and a donor's cheque is not consent. I was trying to protect something that was never mine to sell.

Reed DeLabel

Victim relationship: You found an archival document that contradicted the Star Bowl label. Grant told your department your fellowship could disappear if you pushed it.

Hidden complication: You have not yet told Art that your discovery also undermines one sentence in his published research.

Innocent route: Your printed movement account is true. You did not poison Grant. Your other secret is real; follow your printed speeches even when they reveal it.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I concealed that my finding undermined Dr. Art E. Fact's research. My account of the evening was true. The brass gallery clock was ten minutes fast: the time I quoted from it belongs ten minutes earlier, before the alcove closed. My concealed business explains the suspicion around me. I did not poison Grant, and I will answer for my own secret without accepting his murder.

Murderer Coming Clean: I found a document, not a career opportunity. An archival document contradicted the Star Bowl label. I found it. Grant told my department my fellowship could disappear if I pushed the issue. I could lose the position I worked for simply by insisting that our label tell the truth. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: I found a document, not a career opportunity. An archival document contradicted the Star Bowl label. I found it. Grant told my department my fellowship could disappear if I pushed the issue. I could lose the position I worked for simply by insisting that our label tell the truth.

Opportunity / innocent: Inside the alcove I copied the accession wording while the brass gallery clock showed 6:45. I spent the last minutes before the toast at the outer table comparing that wording with my notes. I wish the discrepancy had been a spelling mistake.

Opportunity / murderer: At about 6:45 by my phone, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to compare the inscription with the card on the cabinet's velvet shelf. One missing word can be a surprisingly expensive problem. I took Grant the catalogue correction at his salon.

Method speech / both branches: My archival discovery also undermines a sentence in Dr. Art E. Fact's work. I had not told him. I was afraid of losing his support and my fellowship at once. The original document is what matters, even when it embarrasses someone I admire. I should have said that before a room full of people had to ask.

Al Baster

Victim relationship: Grant planned to replace your commissioned entrance sculpture with a cheaper replica after the opening and dispute your final payment.

Hidden complication: You built one internal support differently from the approved plan because the fabricator missed a deadline.

Innocent route: You did not poison Grant. Your printed early-cabinet inspection is invented to hide your private scandal. Its details come from an obsolete proposal. Your later position outside the alcove is true. Admit the invented early errand only in Coming Clean.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme.

Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I changed an internal sculpture support from the approved plan. My claim to check the velvet shelf under the object was invented. I borrowed that detail from the abandoned cabinet proposal to conceal my preparations. At the toast I really was outside the alcove in the East Gallery, as I told you. That false errand covered my other misconduct; I did not poison Grant Larceny.

Murderer Coming Clean: My invoice was quite specific. Grant wanted to replace my commissioned entrance sculpture with a cheaper replica after opening night and dispute my final payment. He would still have the photographs of my work at his gala. I would have the invoice and an empty plinth. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: My invoice was quite specific. Grant wanted to replace my commissioned entrance sculpture with a cheaper replica after opening night and dispute my final payment. He would still have the photographs of my work at his gala. I would have the invoice and an empty plinth.

Opportunity / innocent: Earlier, about 6:34 by my watch, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to check the velvet shelf under the object. At the toast I was outside the alcove in the East Gallery. My restricted-area photograph was not for sale. My invoice was quite specific.

Opportunity / murderer: I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to test the velvet-covered shelf supporting the bowl. That was about 6:46; I checked my watch. A sculptor notices what everyone else assumes will hold. I had approached his salon about the restricted-area photograph.

Method speech / both branches: I changed an internal sculpture support because the fabricator missed the deadline. It differs from the approved

plan. Grant wanted photographs of my work without paying for it. I wanted payment and a standing sculpture. An object that needs a structural inspection is not evidence that its maker has poisoned the patron.

Ella Gance

Victim relationship: Grant knew you quietly sold a work you had publicly promised to donate to another institution and planned to expose the contradiction.

Hidden complication: You sold it to cover a failed business investment and hoped to replace it before anyone noticed.

Innocent route: Your printed movement account is true. You did not poison Grant. Your other secret is real; follow your printed speeches even when they reveal it.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I sold a work I had promised to donate. My account of the evening was true. The brass gallery clock was ten minutes fast: the time I quoted from it belongs ten minutes earlier, before the alcove closed. My concealed business explains the suspicion around me. I did not poison Grant, and I will answer for my own secret without accepting his murder.

Murderer Coming Clean: Elegance requires discretion. Grant preferred a microphone. I sold a work I had publicly promised to donate to another institution. Grant knew and planned to expose the contradiction tonight. It was an ugly position, and he was preparing to turn my embarrassment into entertainment for the entire room. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle

installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: Elegance requires discretion. Grant preferred a microphone. I sold a work I had publicly promised to donate to another institution. Grant knew and planned to expose the contradiction tonight. It was an ugly position, and he was preparing to turn my embarrassment into entertainment for the entire room.

Opportunity / innocent: When the brass clock said 6:44, I admired the glaze from inside the display alcove. I was on the gallery balcony by the time of the toast. I needed a little distance from Grant, and not solely to appreciate the composition.

Opportunity / murderer: My last inspection was inside the Star Bowl alcove, about 6:43 by the service-desk clock. I went there to admire the blue glaze beside the cabinet's polished brass corner posts. I wanted to know whether the object or the lighting deserved the applause. I tried to recover my purchase papers at the salon doorway.

Method speech / both branches: I sold a work I had promised to donate, after a business investment failed. I hoped to replace it before anyone noticed. Grant noticed. I have cultivated the impression that everything in my life is beautifully arranged. This was not. I was preparing to own the embarrassment rather than let him stage it for me.

Drew Conclusions

Victim relationship: Grant discovered that you write an anonymous satirical newsletter skewering museum patrons and planned to unmask you during his speech.

Hidden complication: Several jokes in the newsletter came from private conversations, and you regret at least one of them.

Innocent route: Your printed movement account is true. You did not poison Grant. Your other secret is real; follow your printed speeches even when they reveal it.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I wrote the anonymous newsletter, including a joke I regret. My account of the evening was true. My late task was outside the sealed display alcove. Any inspection I made inside it was earlier, before the emergency closure. My concealed business explains the suspicion around me. I did not poison Grant, and I will answer for my own secret without accepting his murder.

Murderer Coming Clean: I have written kinder reviews of broken chairs. I write the anonymous newsletter that makes fun of museum patrons. Grant found out and planned to unmask me in his speech. Those patrons commission my other work. Losing anonymity could cost me rather more than a polite laugh. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: I have written kinder reviews of broken chairs. I write the anonymous newsletter that makes fun of museum patrons. Grant found out and planned to unmask me in his speech. Those patrons commission my other work. Losing anonymity could cost me rather more than a polite laugh.

Opportunity / innocent: At roughly 6:45 by my watch I was outside the alcove, writing in the East Gallery. I had read the inner dedication at 6:30. There is an excellent review in this evening, provided nobody insists that the donor approve my adjectives. I was criticizing the obsolete drawing of the enclosed cabinet. Reviewing a proposal outside the alcove is not working inside its display.

Opportunity / murderer: At about 6:44 by my phone, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to read the tiny dedication fastened behind the sliding front glass. The dedication was practically begging for a review. Grant asked me to bring the review copy to his salon.

Method speech / both branches: I write the anonymous newsletter about museum patrons. Some jokes came from private conversations, and one went farther than I intended. Grant planned to unmask me. There is material here for several cruel columns. I would prefer to be questioned about the one I actually wrote.

Brie DeVivre

Victim relationship: Grant had refused to approve the final catering invoice and planned to blame you for a last-minute service change he personally ordered.

Hidden complication: You changed his private beverage setup twice because Grant and his assistant gave contradictory instructions.

Innocent route: Your printed movement account is true. You did not poison Grant. Your other secret is real; follow your printed speeches even when they reveal it.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I changed Grant's private service setup twice under contradictory instructions. My account of the evening was true. My late task was outside the sealed display alcove. Any inspection I made inside it was earlier, before the emergency closure. My concealed business explains the suspicion around me. I did not poison Grant, and I will answer for my own secret without accepting his murder.

Murderer Coming Clean: The customer was certainly not always right. Grant personally ordered a last-minute service change, refused to approve the final catering invoice, then planned to blame the change on me. He had eaten very well. He simply did not want to pay for it or admit it was his idea. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: The customer was certainly not always right. Grant personally ordered a last-minute service change, refused to approve the final catering invoice, then planned to blame the change on me. He had eaten very well. He simply did not want to pay for it or admit it was his idea.

Opportunity / innocent: At 6:46 by the kitchen clock I was at the service desk in the gallery entrance. The staff poured Grant's cordial then. I did not enter the bowl's display alcove; I was trying to stop dinner from becoming another last-minute donor instruction. My team delivered the empty coupe; I checked the salon arrangement.

Opportunity / murderer: I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to wipe the brass corner nearest the service route before the toast. That was about 6:45; I checked my watch. Apparently the caterer is expected to rescue the furniture as well. My team delivered the empty coupe; I checked the salon arrangement.

Method speech / both branches: Grant and his assistant gave contradictory beverage orders. I changed his private setup twice. The delivery ticket records the final arrangement: an empty coupe first, then cordial at 6:46, without garnish. I handled linen and supplies as part of service. A change of glass can sound sinister after a death. Before it, it was an extremely irritating catering instruction.

Cary Crates

Victim relationship: Grant saw you damage a minor frame during installation and threatened to have you fired after the gala, despite the damage being repairable.

Hidden complication: You concealed the crack with a reversible mount until Chip could inspect it after opening night.

Innocent route: Your printed movement account is true. You did not poison Grant. Your other secret is real; follow your printed speeches even when they reveal it.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I concealed a damaged frame with a reversible mount. My account of the evening was true. My late task was outside the sealed display alcove. Any inspection I made inside it was earlier, before the emergency closure. My concealed business explains the suspicion around me. I did not poison Grant, and I will answer for my own secret without accepting his murder.

Murderer Coming Clean: I made a mistake that could be repaired. I damaged a minor frame during installation. It could be repaired, but Grant threatened to have me fired after the gala. I was ready to put it right. He seemed much more interested in demonstrating that he could end my job. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: I made a mistake that could be repaired. I damaged a minor frame during installation. It could be repaired, but Grant threatened to have me fired after the gala. I was ready to put it right. He seemed much more interested in demonstrating that he could end my job.

Opportunity / innocent: I checked the cradle inside the alcove at 6:35 by the receiving-room clock. Around quarter to seven I was at the outer table dealing with a damaged frame. One was a routine check. The other was the reason I was avoiding Grant. I left a receiving docket in the salon.

Opportunity / murderer: My last inspection was inside the Star Bowl alcove, about 6:46 by the service-desk clock. I went there to inspect the seam where the velvet shelf met the rear glass wall. When an object falls, they remember the handler before they remember gravity. I left a receiving docket in the salon.

Method speech / both branches: I cracked a minor frame during installation and hid the crack with a reversible mount until Chip could inspect it. Grant threatened my job. The broken crate seal concerns the shipment, not that crack. There are two untidy stories here. Please do not join them merely because my name appears nearby.

Anne E. Dote

Victim relationship: Grant's gift conditions would cut public education programming to fund a private donor lounge and VIP entrance.

Hidden complication: You organized an anonymous staff petition against the plan and slipped copies into trustee folders.

Innocent route: Your printed movement account is true. You did not poison Grant. Your other secret is real; follow your printed speeches even when they reveal it.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented

alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I organized the anonymous staff petition against the education cuts. My account of the evening was true. My late task was outside the sealed display alcove. Any inspection I made inside it was earlier, before the emergency closure. My concealed business explains the suspicion around me. I did not poison Grant, and I will answer for my own secret without accepting his murder.

Murderer Coming Clean: The children were not invited to negotiate the budget. Grant's gift conditions would cut school tours and community education to pay for a private donor lounge and VIP entrance. The children would get less museum so his friends could get more privacy. I wanted those conditions taken out. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: The children were not invited to negotiate the budget. Grant's gift conditions would cut school tours and community education to pay for a private donor lounge and VIP entrance. The children would get less museum so his friends could get more privacy. I wanted those conditions taken out.

Opportunity / innocent: I copied the school-tour wording inside the alcove at 6:34 by my phone. At 6:44 I was at the gallery entrance sorting trustee folders. Schoolchildren would have asked much better questions than the trustees were asking.

Opportunity / murderer: At about 6:43 by my phone, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to copy the wording inside the cabinet after sliding the front pane aside. Children ask excellent questions about very bad labels. I took my school-tour proposal to the salon for Grant.

Method speech / both branches: I organized the anonymous staff petition and slipped copies into trustee folders. Grant's donor lounge would have

cost the children their tours. My secret campaign was paperwork. It was quite capable of ruining his announcement without anybody ruining his ability to attend it.

Faye Stop

Victim relationship: Grant ordered you to surrender a photograph showing him meeting privately with Hugh beside a shell-company shipping file.

Hidden complication: You kept a backup print after agreeing to delete the image from your camera.

Innocent route: Your printed movement account is true. You did not poison Grant. Your other secret is real; follow your printed speeches even when they reveal it.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I kept a backup photograph Grant ordered deleted. My account of the evening was true. My late task was outside the sealed display alcove. Any inspection I made inside it was earlier, before the emergency closure. My concealed business explains the suspicion around me. I did not poison Grant, and I will answer for my own secret without accepting his murder.

Murderer Coming Clean: He asked me to delete the wrong photograph. I photographed Grant meeting Hugh beside a shell-company shipping file. Grant ordered me to surrender the photograph. I agreed to delete it from my camera, but kept a backup print. I was not comfortable letting him decide which pictures could exist. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others

lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: He asked me to delete the wrong photograph. I photographed Grant meeting Hugh beside a shell-company shipping file. Grant ordered me to surrender the photograph. I agreed to delete it from my camera, but kept a backup print. I was not comfortable letting him decide which pictures could exist.

Opportunity / innocent: My camera logged 6:35 when I photographed the back of the mount inside the alcove. At about 6:45 I was taking balcony photographs. I kept a different print Grant wanted destroyed. It does not suddenly vanish because the subject dislikes the lighting.

Opportunity / murderer: I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to photograph the bowl through the opening in the sliding glass front. That was about 6:44; I checked my watch. The beautiful front already had enough admirers. I had delivered the donor photographs to his salon.

Method speech / both branches: I kept a backup of the photograph Grant told me to delete. I agreed to remove the camera copy; the print survived. I also photographed the mount during setup. There are times in the camera records that can be checked, and household-looking clocks in pictures that should not be treated as camera records. A photograph is evidence. The subject's irritation is not a correction.

Robin Banks

Victim relationship: Grant had you removed from a previous museum event and threatened legal action if you disrupted tonight's unveiling.

Hidden complication: You planted small 'PROVENANCE IS A VERB' stickers in several gallery brochures for a peaceful protest.

Innocent route: Your printed movement account is true. You did not poison Grant. Your other secret is real; follow your printed speeches even when they reveal it.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with

museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I planted peaceful protest stickers in the brochures. My account of the evening was true. My late task was outside the sealed display alcove. Any inspection I made inside it was earlier, before the emergency closure. My concealed business explains the suspicion around me. I did not poison Grant, and I will answer for my own secret without accepting his murder.

Murderer Coming Clean: A protest does not require his permission. Grant had me removed from a previous museum event. He threatened legal action if I disrupted this unveiling. My protest concerns restitution, not his comfort. He wanted silence tonight, and I was not ready to promise him that. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: A protest does not require his permission. Grant had me removed from a previous museum event. He threatened legal action if I disrupted this unveiling. My protest concerns restitution, not his comfort. He wanted silence tonight, and I was not ready to promise him that.

Opportunity / innocent: At 6:43 by my phone I was outside the display alcove, in the East Gallery, slipping protest stickers into brochures. Peaceful protest, to be precise. Grant's solicitor would prefer a much more theatrical description.

Opportunity / murderer: My last inspection was inside the Star Bowl alcove, about 6:45 by the service-desk clock. I went there to read the ownership card on the velvet shelf inside the cabinet. I intended to quote its words

rather than improve them by accident. I approached his salon about the ownership records.

Method speech / both branches: I put “PROVENANCE IS A VERB” stickers into the gallery brochures. It was a peaceful protest and entirely intentional. I handled linen and supplies while preparing it. Grant threatened legal action if I disrupted his unveiling. I intended a room full of awkward questions. If that sounds organized, good: a protest should have a plan.

Penny Pincher

Victim relationship: One decorative object in the exhibition once belonged to your family. You believe Grant acquired it through a manipulative private sale decades ago.

Hidden complication: You brought old correspondence proving your family contested that sale and planned to confront him tonight.

Innocent route: Your printed movement account is true. You did not poison Grant. Your other secret is real; follow your printed speeches even when they reveal it.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant’s empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I brought the letters disputing the sale of my family’s object. My account of the evening was true. The brass gallery clock was ten minutes fast: the time I quoted from it belongs ten minutes earlier, before the alcove closed. My concealed business explains the suspicion around me. I did not poison Grant, and I will answer for my own secret without accepting his murder.

Murderer Coming Clean: My family kept the letters. An object here once belonged to my family. I believe Grant acquired it through a manipulative

private sale decades ago. Seeing it celebrated as his generosity is difficult. I want the history acknowledged and the ownership questioned. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: My family kept the letters. An object here once belonged to my family. I believe Grant acquired it through a manipulative private sale decades ago. Seeing it celebrated as his generosity is difficult. I want the history acknowledged and the ownership questioned.

Opportunity / innocent: I looked beneath the bowl's rim inside the alcove when the brass gallery clock showed 6:46. Later I sat near the gallery entrance with my family letters. I was prepared for an argument about ownership, not another lecture about generosity.

Opportunity / murderer: At about 6:46 by my phone, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to look beneath the bowl's rim through the opened sliding front pane. An old family letter is more convincing when the object agrees. I had brought a photograph of my family object to Grant's salon.

Method speech / both branches: The old letters show my family disputed the sale. I brought them to confront Grant, who preferred to call the object a generous gift. I had access to the setup key and linen. Neither makes the letters disappear. I wanted the ownership questioned in front of witnesses. I have waited years for an answer; I was not planning to make the person owing it permanently unavailable.

Justin Tyme

Victim relationship: Grant fed you several flattering claims for an earlier profile that you later discovered were exaggerated. He threatened to cut off access if you corrected them.

Hidden complication: You are preparing a correction that will also make you look embarrassingly credulous.

Innocent route: Your printed movement account is true. You did not poison Grant. Your other secret is real; follow your printed speeches even when they reveal it.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I prepared a correction to the flattering profile Grant fed me. My account of the evening was true. My late task was outside the sealed display alcove. Any inspection I made inside it was earlier, before the emergency closure. My concealed business explains the suspicion around me. I did not poison Grant, and I will answer for my own secret without accepting his murder.

Murderer Coming Clean: A source does not get to write his own correction. Grant supplied flattering claims for my earlier profile that I later found were exaggerated. He threatened to cut off access if I corrected them. I would either lose an important source or leave my name on reporting I no longer trusted. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: A source does not get to write his own correction. Grant supplied flattering claims for my earlier profile that I later found were exaggerated. He threatened to cut off access if I corrected them. I would either lose an important source or leave my name on reporting I no longer trusted.

Opportunity / innocent: At 6:32 by my watch I copied the date inside the alcove. I was outside in the East Gallery by quarter to seven, drafting a

correction. I wanted it finished before Grant could turn my deadline into his bargaining chip.

Opportunity / murderer: I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to copy the date through the glass and check it under the internal lamp. That was about 6:43; I checked my watch. I would prefer not to make publishing corrections a hobby. I took Grant the local-history clipping at the salon doorway.

Method speech / both branches: I am correcting the flattering claims Grant supplied for my earlier profile. Publishing the correction will make me look credulous. I used museum supplies while assembling my notes. Grant threatened to end my access if I went ahead. I was working toward a deadline and an embarrassing byline. The correction is still necessary, however spectacularly the evening has gone off schedule.

Minnie Malist

Victim relationship: Grant ordered you to add a gaudy lighting cue to the unveiling and threatened to withhold payment when Frank objected.

Hidden complication: You secretly changed the cue again after approval, causing the eerie light flickers guests noticed during Act I.

Innocent route: Your printed movement account is true. You did not poison Grant. Your other secret is real; follow your printed speeches even when they reveal it.

Murderer route: You stole the conservation toxin during setup and wiped it onto the inside rim of Grant's empty coupe between 6:40 and 6:44 with museum linen. You acted alone. Your claimed late visit inside the Star Bowl alcove is an invented alibi based on the obsolete printed gala programme. Do not reveal this private instruction before Coming Clean. Your invented alcove work relies on the obsolete enclosed-cabinet proposal. You missed the open-cradle installation; keep that false story until Coming Clean.

Innocent Coming Clean: I changed the lighting cue after approval and caused the flicker. My account of the evening was true. My late task was outside the sealed display alcove. Any inspection I made inside it was earlier, before the emergency closure. My concealed business explains the

suspicion around me. I did not poison Grant, and I will answer for my own secret without accepting his murder.

Murderer Coming Clean: One more donor instruction. Of course. Grant ordered a gaudy lighting cue for the unveiling. Frank objected, and Grant threatened to withhold my payment. I was caught between the person designing the display and the person holding the money. Neither planned to share the blame. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Motive speech: One more donor instruction. Of course. Grant ordered a gaudy lighting cue for the unveiling. Frank objected, and Grant threatened to withhold my payment. I was caught between the person designing the display and the person holding the money. Neither planned to share the blame.

Opportunity / innocent: At 6:45 by the show-control desk clock I was at the outer console in the East Gallery. I had checked the dedication inside the alcove at 6:33. I was adjusting the lights, which is very different from being inside the object display. I discussed his lighting demands at the salon doorway.

Opportunity / murderer: My last inspection was inside the Star Bowl alcove, about 6:44 by the service-desk clock. I went there to adjust the tiny internal lamp above the dedication card. If a donor's name looks crooked, somebody inevitably invoices the producer. I discussed his lighting demands at the salon doorway.

Method speech / both branches: I changed the lighting cue after approval. Grant demanded a gaudy display; Frank objected; I was caught in the middle. My later edit caused the flicker. The emergency security curtain had its own controller, separate from my lighting console. I can own a bad lighting decision without claiming that every machine in the museum belongs to me.